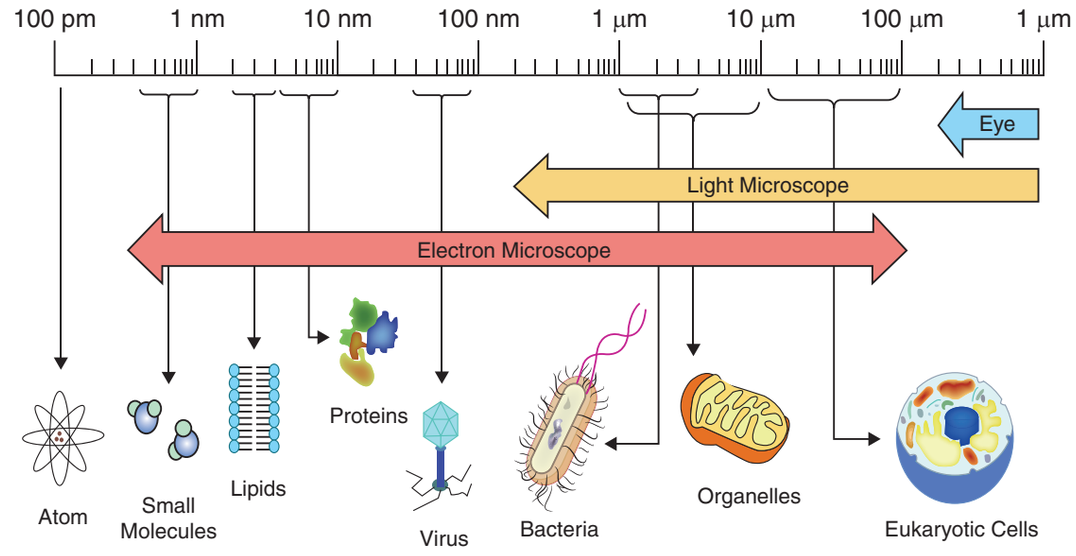


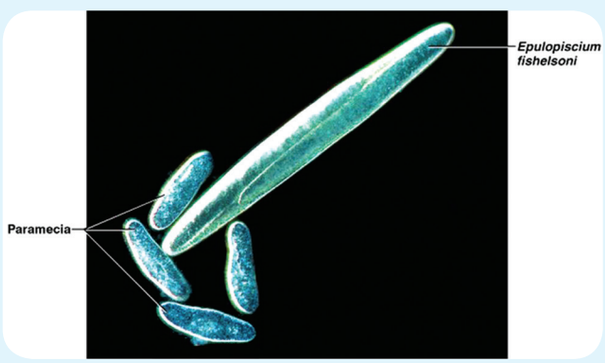
Figure 7.2: Metric unit of measurement

depends upon environmental and growth condition. Medically important bacteria ranges from 0.2 – 1.5 μm in diameter and 3-5μm in length (Figure 7.2).

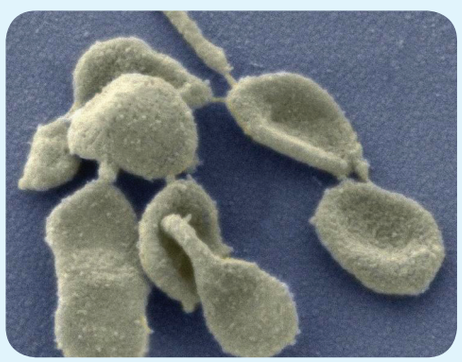
1 metre (m)	=	1000mm (millimeter)
1mm (10^{-3}m)	=	1000 μm (micrometer)
1 μm (10^{-6}m)	=	1000nm (nanometer)
1nm (10^{-9}m)	=	1000pm (picometer)
1A^0 (10^{-10}m) (angstrom)		

Infobits

The smallest bacteria is *Mycoplasma genitalium*, which has a diameter of 200-300nm. The largest and longest bacterium is *Thiomargarita namibiensis* (750μm) found in the ocean sediments in the continental shelf of Namibia. They are large enough to be visible to the naked eye. The previously known largest bacterial cell *Epulopiscium fishelsoni* is found only in the intestinal tract of certain topical fish over 500μm long. *Epulopiscium* means "guest at the table of fish".



Epulopiscium fishelsoni



Mycoplasma genitalium

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